

```
$arr=array(1,2,3,4,5);  
echo "The third element is {$arr[3]}."  
?>
```

The output of the above program is as follows:
The third element is 4.

You can easily access the characters that are inserted within the strings. Here, mention the zero based offset of the expected character just after the string in curly braces.

Example:

```
<?php  
$str = "This is string";  
$a = $str{0};  
$b = $str{2};  
$c = "This is also a string";  
$d = $str{strlen($str)-1};  
echo $a."<br>";  
echo $b."<br>";  
echo $c."<br>";  
echo $d."<br>";  
?>
```

The output of the above program is as follows:

```
T  
i  
This is also a string  
g
```

You can convert a value to a string by using a string cast. Here, the `strval()` function can also be used. The `echo()` and the `print()` functions are used to automatically convert a string in the scope of an expression, if a string is needed here. This can also be done while comparing a string to a variable. A PHP engine converts a 'TRUE' value to the '1' string while the 'FALSE' value is converted to an empty string. Similarly, you can also convert an integer or a float to a string. The exponential notation is used to convert a floating point number.

Example:

```
<?php  
$foo = 1 + "10.5"; // $foo is
```